

AI Design Thinking and AI Opportunity Mapping

Opportunity mapping · Miro process board · 33A AI cards · Guardrails · Human in the loop

1. Topic Overview

Session 8 was a fully hands-on workshop, no theory at all. Karandeep Grover, CEO at AtliQ, walked the cohort through **AI opportunity mapping**, the exact activity AtliQ runs with clients during the discovery phase of an AI project. The session sat right next to the design thinking work from the previous day: yesterday the cohort learned how to ask the right questions and uncover the real root cause of a problem, and today they moved into solutioning, mapping where AI can actually help inside a real workflow.

The whole session ran on a single Miro board with a recruitment problem as the live case. Karan kept repeating one rule throughout: AI is just a tool, and what matters is making your user's life easier, not picking a clever technology. Aakash Pardeshi, Ayush, Srikanth, and Pranav moderated the session in support.

Area covered	What the session delivered
AI opportunity mapping	The bridge from problem discovery to solutioning: take a workflow, break it into steps, and map where AI fits.
The Miro process board	A colour-coded canvas for human actions, digital tools, pain points, and guardrails.
33A AI cards	A deck of seed-idea cards used to spark AI use cases for each step.
The recruitment case	Mapping the full hire-to-offer process for an overloaded AtliQ recruiter.
A worked example	Automating one step (job posting) end to end, including new pain points and guardrails.
Breakout practice	Teams applied the same loop to resume screening, shortlisting, and profile scanning.

Industry Context

This is real consulting work, not a classroom exercise. Karan said he and Dhaval used the same method to automate several Codebasics steps in about 30 to 35 minutes once they were warmed up. The finished map is what a technical team picks up to build from, and it feeds directly into the AI BRD (the Business Requirements Document for an AI project) and later documentation.

2. What AI Opportunity Mapping Is

Opportunity mapping sounds like jargon, but the idea is simple. Once you have discovered the root cause of a problem using the methods from the previous session (the MOM test, jobs to be done, empathy, persona, and the five whys), the next move is to map where AI can help inside the steps of that process. You lay out the steps a user performs when they work with a software or digital product, then you ask where AI is appropriate. AI does not have to be used in every step, only where it genuinely helps.

Karan was clear that these phases blur into each other. There is no clean exit gate where problem discovery ends and opportunity mapping begins. You can run today's mapping even without doing yesterday's discovery first, and you can skip parts of the process when they do not add value. There are also many frameworks beyond MOM and jobs to be done, such as MoSCoW analysis, so treat the method as flexible, not as a rigid recipe.

Key Insight

Yesterday was about finding the right problem. Today is about solutioning. Opportunity mapping is the hinge between the two: it turns a confirmed root cause into a concrete picture of where AI earns its place in the workflow.

3. The Miro Process Board and Its Colour Code

The activity lives on a Miro board with a central process board plus supporting sections. The board captures, for every step, what a human is doing now, what a human will do once AI is in place, what digital tools and platforms do now, what they will do after AI, the current pain points, and the guardrails. Miro is just a canvas tool here; Karan noted Figma and Canva can do the same job. The only real requirement is a canvas where you can copy, paste, type, and arrange information.

A consistent colour nomenclature carries the whole board, and it is worth memorising because every step reuses it.

Colour	Meaning
Green	A trigger or input by a human.
Yellow	Fixed steps that happen to achieve the process.
Purple	Digital tools and platforms in place, existing tools, and AI features. Anything digital.
Red	Pain points.
Orange	Risk mitigation and guardrails.

One practical note from the session: on a shared Miro board, copy and paste is the only reliable way to move sticky notes and dots, because dragging is painful and selecting a card or the whole board locks it for everyone else. Keep your cursor still when you are not the active editor.

4. The Live Case: An Overloaded Recruiter

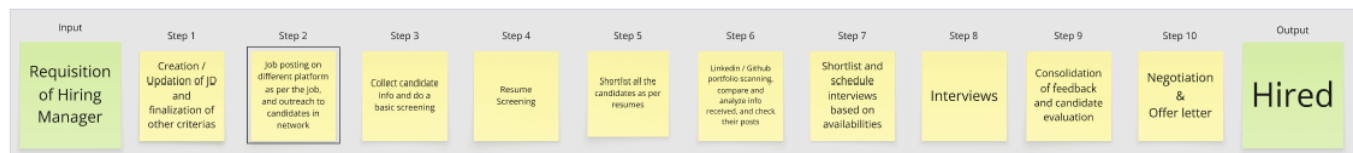
The problem statement was deliberately real. Yukta, the HR at AtliQ, is the only recruiter, and she is struggling to screen candidates, arrange interviews, coordinate different interviewers, and get results back on time, all at once. Because AtliQ and Codebasics are so active on LinkedIn, a single post can bring in 500 resumes. Getting resumes is the easy part; everything that follows is exhausting. The goal for the session was to make Yukta's life easier by mapping where AI could carry some of that load.

Key Insight

Pick a use case where the pain is obvious and the volume is high. A single recruiter drowning in 500 resumes is a clean candidate for AI, because the bottleneck is real, repetitive, and easy for stakeholders to recognise.

5. Mapping the As-Is Process

The first half of the activity was to define the recruitment process at a high level, from the input (a requisition raised by a hiring manager) to the output (a candidate is hired). Volunteers and the audience built the steps together, and Karan kept pushing everyone to stay high level and avoid nitty gritty details. The steps the cohort settled on are below. Note that they are intentionally rough; in a real session you would refine, merge, or split them.



The recruitment process as mapped on the Miro board, running from the input (requisition raised by the team) through ten steps to the output (candidate hired). Step 2, posting to job and recruitment boards, is the step the cohort automated as the worked example.

For each step the teams then filled in three things on the board: what a human does today, what digital tools and platforms support that work, and the pain points with the current way of working. The full as-is map is captured below.

Step	Actions by humans	Digital tools and platforms in use	Pain points with the current solution
Input: requisition of		Internal requisition or HR system.	The trigger that kicks off everything below.

Step	Actions by humans	Digital tools and platforms in use	Pain points with the current solution
the hiring manager	The hiring manager raises a requisition to start the process.		
1. Creation or updation of the JD and finalising other criteria	Pull details from the requisition form; look up whether a relevant JD already exists and matches the exact requirements; if it partly matches, copy and edit it, otherwise create a new JD; send it for approval and get feedback from the hiring manager.	SharePoint or another document or JD management tool to search, edit, and create JDs with the extra criteria; email, Teams, or an HR tool to capture the hiring manager's approval.	Many JDs get recreated each time because experience level, role name, and other criteria vary; JD creation and approval is human-driven and adds little value.
2. Job posting on different platforms and outreach	Collect the JD and create the content for each platform to post; run outreach to candidates in the network; cross-check the postings and bring incoming data back to a central place.	LinkedIn Jobs, Indeed, Naukri, and similar boards to post the openings, plus company career sites and third-party career websites.	Going and posting on each platform separately; approaching staffing firms for leads; verifying every platform holds the correct details.
3. Collect candidate info and basic screening	Review the major criteria from the JD; shortlist only those who match; apply a basic priority filter.	Filter profiles on the interview portal; an Excel sheet to track status.	Consolidating the candidate details in one place; manually reviewing all the details.
4. Resume screening	Review resumes for the required skills, education, requirements, and work authorisation; find the matching context against the JD; search for important keywords.	ATS system screening on the basis of different criteria.	Strong candidates get missed because the ATS is keyword-based; algorithm bias; auto-rejection with no reasoning.
5. Shortlist all candidates as per resumes	The recruiter reviews and shortlists the candidates, giving a go or no-go to move each one forward.	Shortlisting by matching keywords to the job criteria; identifying candidates with a higher coverage of the requirements; producing	Maintaining reviews and findings in Excel; emotional bias.

Step	Actions by humans	Digital tools and platforms in use	Pain points with the current solution
		the candidate list to take forward.	
6. LinkedIn and GitHub portfolio scanning	The hiring manager reviews LinkedIn for relevance and background or red flags; cross-verifies the skills in the resume against LinkedIn posts and recommendations; checks whether the candidate's mindset aligns; repeats this for every candidate.	Matching skills with the job role (ATS) across multiple platforms; scoring the resume on experience and skills.	Manually checking each candidate's profile across different platforms; repetitive and time-consuming.
7. Shortlist and schedule interviews based on availability	Connect with the assigned interviewers to find their availability; reach out to candidates to confirm the slot; send interview invites to all relevant parties.	MS Teams or Slack to find interviewer availability; phone call or email to reach candidates; email to send the invites.	Many back-and-forth mails to coordinate; rescheduling from last-minute conflicts; time-zone differences.
8. Interviews	Run the interview sequence: a quick initial technical screen, a technical round, an assignment with evaluation, then a final technical round and culture fit.	Teams, Zoom, Google Meet; coding platforms like LeetCode; feedback collection forms.	Not always having fixed metrics for candidate evaluation; personal bias toward candidates; delay in feedback.
9. Consolidation of feedback and candidate evaluation	Collect feedback from all interviewers for a candidate; assign weightage to the feedback based on the position on offer; do a final round of evaluation to reach the finalists.	Platforms like Greenhouse or PyjamaHR, or email; internal channels like Slack or Teams.	Chasing feedback when the hiring manager is busy; if someone is on leave the decision stalls and the candidate can be lost.
10. Negotiation and offer letter	Prepare the offer; send it to the candidate; negotiate the salary with the candidate.	Cellular calls or comms platforms like Zoom, Teams, or Google Meet; offers sent by email or via DocuSign or Adobe.	Disconnected systems; the task often needs follow-ups to complete.
Output: hired			

Step	Actions by humans	Digital tools and platforms in use	Pain points with the current solution
	The candidate accepts and is hired.	Offer and onboarding systems.	The end state the whole process drives toward.

Key Insight

Map the current pain points against the current solution, not a future one. A common confusion in the room was associating pain points with the AI solution that does not exist yet. The red notes describe what hurts today, which is exactly what tells you where AI is worth applying.

6. The 33A AI Cards: Seeds, Not Answers

To find AI use cases, the session used a deck of AI cards made by a company called 33A. Each card names an AI capability and, when you flip it, shows a short description and example use cases. The cards are grouped into categories that act as a mnemonic for searching, such as AI finds and organises information, AI gains insights from data and understands the past and present, AI performs tasks, and AI reads and writes.

The single most important point Karan made, repeatedly, is that the cards are seeds for your imagination, not literal instructions. The card itself is not very helpful; what matters is what you make out of it. Two similar cards can both get you to the same objective, so do not agonise over picking the perfect one. Consider the title as direction and the back of the card as context.

Industry Context

The 33A cards are a commercial product. For real or commercial use you buy them from 33a.ai/aicards-order, and for the cohort you use the copies on the Miro board. If you do not have the deck, Karan said you can get the same effect by asking ChatGPT or Claude to generate a list of AI use cases and treating those as your seeds.

7. The Opportunity-Mapping Loop

The heart of the session was a repeatable loop you run on one step at a time. Once you have done it a few times it becomes fast; Karan reckons 20 to 30 minutes per step once you know the cards. The loop:

Stage	What you do
1	Pick one single step, ideally the one with the most pain (the cohort dot-voted, and job posting won).
2	Hold three things in mind for that step: the human task, the platform enablement, and the pain points.
3	Scan the card categories and bring in the relevant seed cards. Aim for around 10, not 30 to 40.
4	As a team, discuss and prioritise down to roughly three cards. Dot voting plus discussion decides it.
5	For each chosen card, write what it actually does for this step in the note below it.
6	Summarise the new AI-enabled step. This summary replaces the old digital-tool step.
7	Redefine the human actions, which should now be minimal: a human triggers and then monitors and validates.
8	Identify the new pain points that the AI solution introduces.
9	Pick risk cards (guardrails) to mitigate those new pain points.

The principle behind the loop is to build a black-boxed view first. You decide what should happen and where AI helps without yet arguing about which model, agent, or tool will do it. Technology selection comes later; the map stays tool-agnostic on purpose.

8. Worked Example: Automating Step 2 (Job Posting)

The cohort took the loop all the way through for step 2, posting the job on multiple platforms. This is the clearest reference for how the method plays out in practice.

8.1 The starting picture

Going into the worked example, step 2 was fully manual: a person tailored content for each job board and posted across them by hand, recreating the content every time because each site asks for something different.

8.2 The AI cards chosen

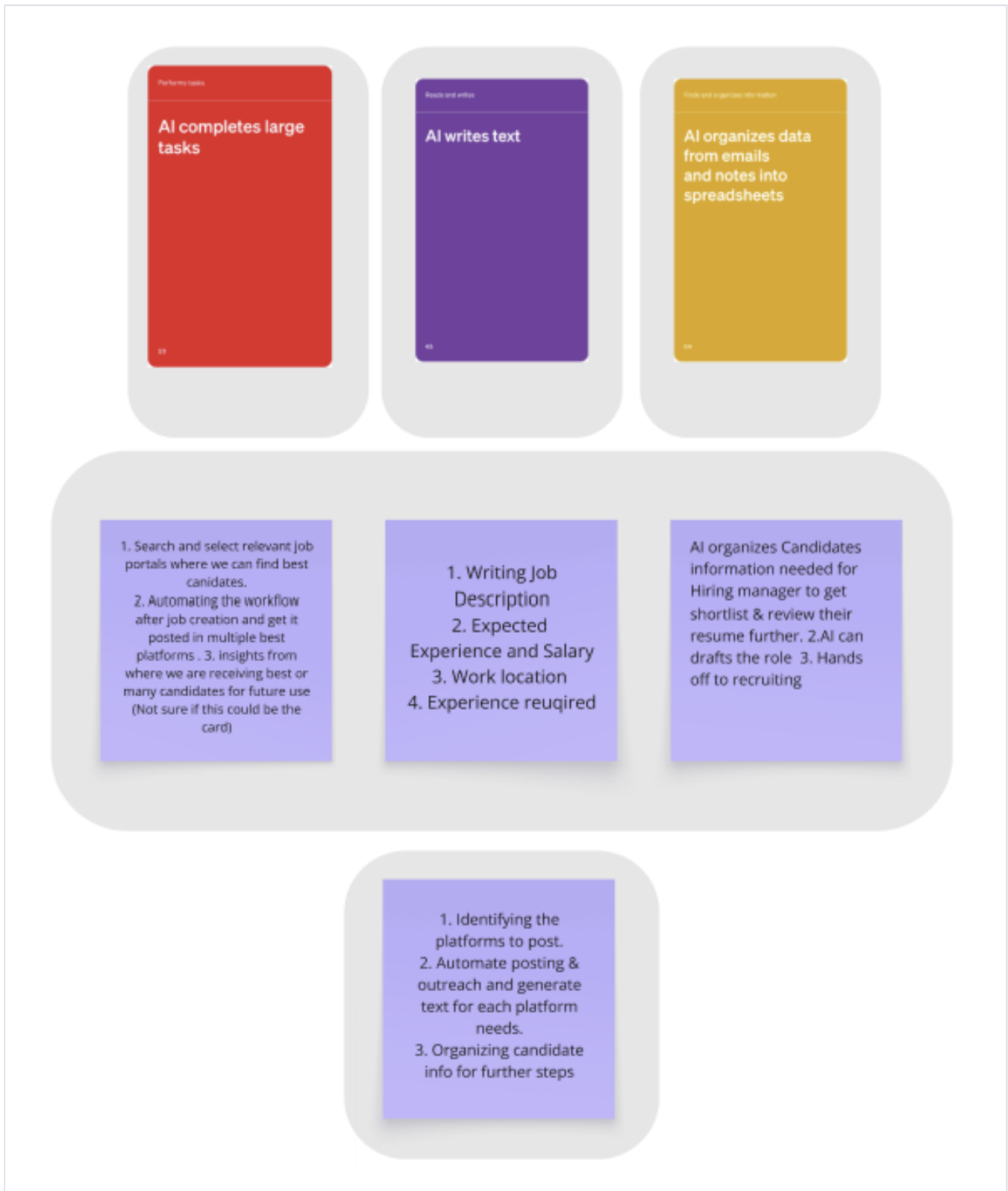
The team first brought in a wide spread of candidate cards for step 2, then talked them down to the few that mattered. The board below shows the cards that were pulled in to start with.

Codebasics | LIVE AI PM Cohort
Session 8 - Study Notes



The 33 AI cards first brought in as candidates for step 2, before prioritising down to a few.

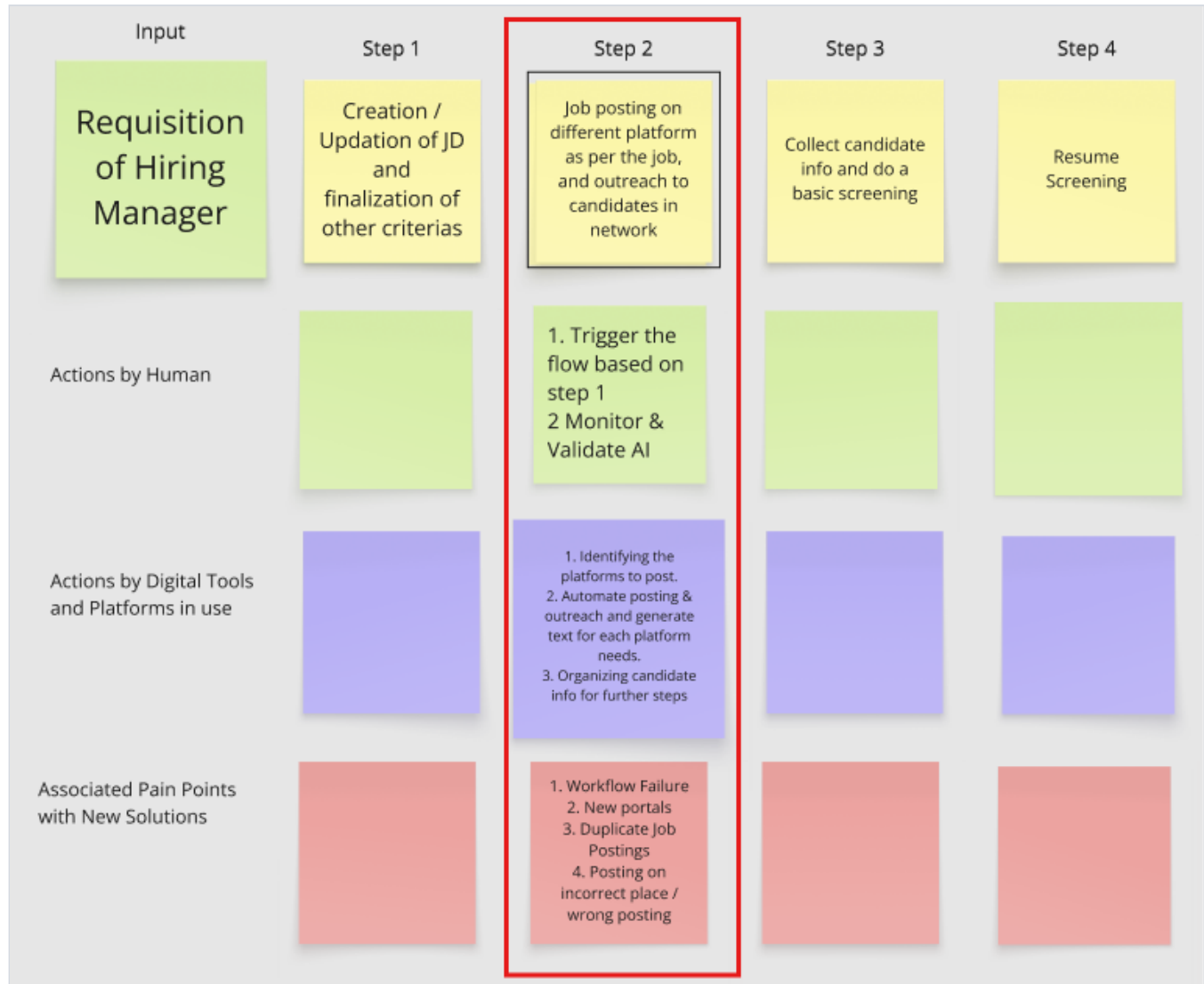
After discussing the options with the learners, the group agreed on three working cards. Not all of them were the learners' first picks: Karan brought a couple in and steered the discussion before the cohort settled on these three. They were **AI completes large tasks**, which breaks a big task into smaller steps and covers posting across multiple platforms (it beat the narrower "perform office task" idea); **AI writes text**, which creates the content and answers the per-platform form questions since each board needs different text; and **AI organises data into spreadsheets**, which collects incoming candidate information ready for the next step. Cards like "AI answers questions and fills forms" and robotic process automation were weighed too, while "understand market and geography" was dropped because it belongs in the requisition phase, and "summarise text" because creating text mattered more than summarising here. This is the prioritisation discipline in action: when the chosen cards already meet a high enough threshold (Trishala framed it as roughly 90 percent of the outcome), you stop adding cards.



The three chosen cards, each with the note the cohort wrote beneath it, and the summary card (bottom) that becomes the new step 2.

8.3 The redefined human role and new pain points

After AI, the human no longer writes and posts. The human simply triggers the flow and then monitors and validates the output, which is the human-in-the-loop pattern. The system identifies the platforms to post on, automates the posting and outreach, generates the text each platform needs, and organises incoming candidates into lists for the next step. New pain points then appear with the new solution: a workflow failure or posting to the wrong vendor, new portals appearing over time, and duplicate job postings.



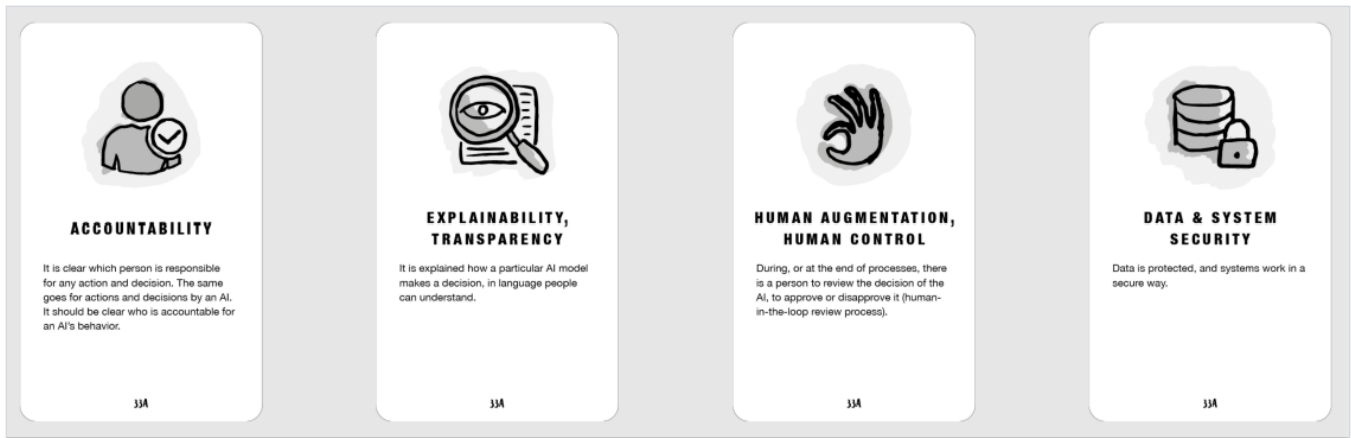
Step 2 redrawn with AI in the lead, showing the redefined human role, the AI actions, and the new pain points.

Key Insight

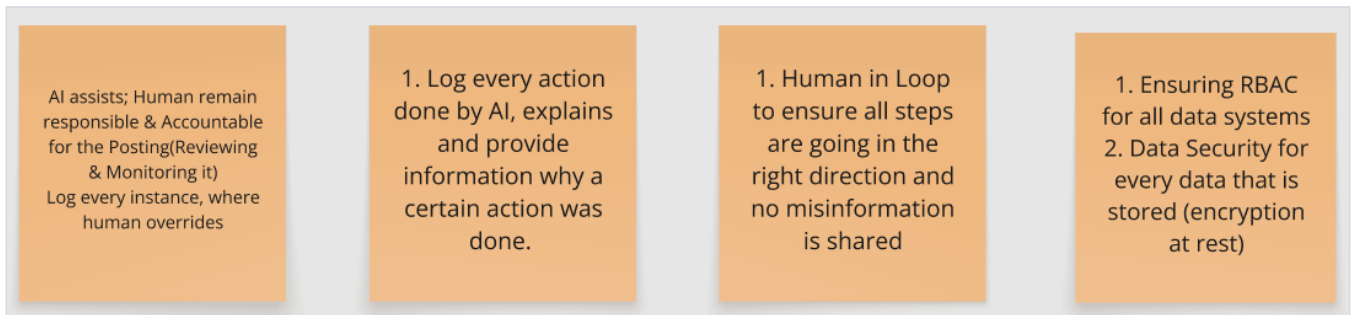
One person's pain point can be another person's enhancement. New job portals appearing was debated: is it a defect or just natural change you build for? Karan's takeaway is that a pain point can legitimately drive a future enhancement, so capture it either way.

8.4 The guardrails

To handle the new pain points, the team pulled in four 33A risk-mitigation cards. The cards below name each guardrail, and under each one the cohort wrote how it applies to step 2.



The four risk-mitigation cards chosen for step 2: Accountability, Explainability and Transparency, Human Augmentation and Human Control, and Data and System Security.



What the cohort wrote under each guardrail for step 2. Accountability: AI assists while humans stay responsible and accountable for the posting (reviewing and monitoring it), and every human override is logged. Explainability and transparency: log every action AI takes and explain why it was done. Human augmentation and control: keep a human in the loop so steps go in the right direction and no misinformation is shared. Data and system security: enforce role-based access control (RBAC) for all data systems and secure every stored record (encryption at rest).

Fairness was discussed but set aside for this step, because posting a job makes no selection decision. Karan flagged it as critical in later steps where the model picks or ranks people, and pointed to Amazon's hiring tool from the last decade as a real case where biased historical data led the model to discriminate against women. The bias was not introduced by any human in the moment; the model simply amplified a prejudiced dataset.

9. Breakout Room Practice (Steps 3 to 6)

After the worked example, teams ran the same loop on the next steps. Group A took step 3, group B step 4, group C step 5, and another group step 6. The review surfaced useful patterns.

Step	What AI takes on, and what to watch
Step 3: collect info and basic screen	AI parses the resume, does a high-level keyword or word-cloud mapping, filters a first set of relevant resumes, and initiates emails (which go to the hiring manager after screening). Avoid duplicating the deeper parsing that belongs in step 5.
Step 4: resume screening	AI reads the resume and matches it against the JD on skills, projects, and experience, comparing context on both sides rather than summarising. Add a bias check. AI must do the rejecting, with sensible thresholds, otherwise humans are left with too much work.
Step 5: shortlisting	Organise applications from many sources, identify anomalies such as faked resumes, detect duplicate resumes across sources, apply fairness, and secure the data and PII. Back every shortlisting decision with a reason.
Step 6: profile scanning	Find associated skills and experience per profile, flag profiles that miss the bar, and compare across sources to catch gaps (a resume claiming four years against a LinkedIn that shows education ending in 2025). Add bot detection, role-based access, encryption, and logging. The funnel should narrow so the human only does the final shortlist.

Key Insight

AI should narrow the funnel, not just hand work back. If a human ends up spending the same time re-screening AI's output, the system has failed. AI has to make real suggestions and real rejections (within thresholds) so each stage genuinely shrinks the pile.

10. Mindset and Role Notes

Karan opened with a blunt message about the PM mindset: to be a successful PM you have to be a self-starter. You cannot wait to be asked to speak and still expect to become an AI PM. PMs are talkers, and even self-described introverts can grow into selective extroverts because the role demands it. Throughout the activity he pushed people to volunteer, speak up, and get hands-on rather than watch.

He was equally clear that this is a team activity, not a solo one. It needs business stakeholders, and the more of them the better, because running the mapping together is how you earn buy-in. When stakeholders sit through the process they feel the pain and see the value for themselves, and the visual board lets you do that without drowning them in technical detail, which usually either confuses or scares non-technical owners. It is also a strong way to surface quick wins.

Key Insight

On keeping up with AI, Karan's honest advice was that you cannot, and trying to track everything gives you nothing but anxiety and FOMO. Make peace with it. Follow only the models that break benchmarks and make the news, lean on a small set you actually use, and get a weekly summary from your team rather than drinking from the firehose.

11. Session Output and Next Steps

By the end the cohort had a full process map for recruitment with one step (job posting) fully automated and several more sketched in the breakout rooms. The map shows the changed step, the human actions, the digital tools, the new pain points, and the guardrails, and it is exactly the artifact a technology team would build from and that feeds the AI BRD.

To keep practising, Karan suggested duplicating the board and filling out steps 7 through 10 yourself. More broadly, practise the loop on real processes in your own organisation, or, if you are not in a corporate setting, use Google, ChatGPT, or Claude to generate processes (for example, the steps in a retail business) and map those. The team also planned an office-hours session during the week for open questions, and Mochitha shared a short feedback form to capture time zones and comments. The Miro board link remains available to everyone.

Item	Detail
Practice task	Duplicate the Miro board and map AI into steps 7 to 10 (interviews, feedback, and offer).
Tools	Miro for the canvas (Figma or Canva work too); 33A AI cards from 33a.ai/aicards-order, or ChatGPT and Claude to generate use cases.
Office hours	A follow-up session to be organised during the week for outstanding doubts.
Feedback	Complete the short feedback form shared in the chat.

12. Quick Revision Summary

Term	What it means
AI opportunity mapping	Taking a confirmed problem, laying out the workflow steps, and mapping where AI can help.
Process board	The Miro canvas holding human actions, digital tools, pain points, and guardrails for each step.
Colour code	Green is a human trigger, yellow is a fixed step, purple is anything digital, red is a pain point, orange is a guardrail.
33A AI cards	Seed-idea cards that spark AI use cases, grouped into categories. Direction, not literal instructions.
Black-box approach	Deciding what AI should do before choosing any model, agent, or tool.
Human in the loop	AI does the heavy lifting while a human triggers, monitors, and validates.

Term	What it means
Guardrail	A risk-mitigation measure: accountability, explainability, security, fairness, human control.
Fairness risk	A model amplifying biased historical data, as in the Amazon hiring example.
Quick win	An early, visible result that earns stakeholder buy-in for the larger AI effort.